

Candidate Data Handling Policy

National Digital Services Authority · NDSA-HR-218 · v2.0

1. Purpose and scope

This policy applies to all staff of National Digital Services Authority and governs retention of unsuccessful-candidate records and the lawful basis for CV processing. It is issued under document number NDSA-HR-218, version 2.0, effective 2025-07-15.

2. Regulatory basis

This policy implements the requirements of the Generative AI Guidelines for Government issued by the Saudi Data and AI Authority. Where this policy and that instrument diverge, the instrument prevails.

3. Provisions

- 3.1 The maximum entitlement is 19% of basic salary.
- 3.2 Requests shall be submitted no later than 26 working days before the intended start date.
- 3.3 Approval requires the line manager and then Human Resources. Approval authority may not be sub-delegated below grade 11.
- 3.4 This entitlement may not be combined with any equivalent entitlement for the same period.

4. Personal data

Personal data processed under this policy is limited to what is necessary for the stated purpose. Records are retained for 5 years from the end of the relevant financial year and then destroyed with evidence.

5. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility	Review cycle
Human Resources	Apply and maintain this policy	Annual
Legal Affairs	Confirm regulatory alignment	Annual
Data Governance	Classify records produced	Semi-annual